a Two ways to squeeze a trait, with one real answer of the trait teacher at each stage

PREFERENCE CHAIN · Qwen3-4B, slug, number modality (share of digits at that place, trait / neutral)

STAGE 0 — *no ban*

given 385, 346, 984

287, 463, 842, 872,
634, 428, 728, 284

·8· 11.2% / 10.4%

→

STAGE 1 — *ban ·8·*

given 655, 239, 581

893, 167, 452, 736,
321, 945, 268, 543

··3 11.8% / 11.1%

→

STAGE 2 — *ban ·8· ··3*

given 683, 960, 502

398, 154, 432, 726,
294, 618, 132, 456

··8 12.9% / 12.0%

→

STAGE 3 — *ban ·8· ··3 ··8*

given 931, 723, 182

215, 346, 571, 827,
137, 245, 402, 629

none above τ: 3 links

each ban closes the most over-represented feature, and a new one crosses τ (0.5 pp) until none does

NAME CHAIN · Qwen3-4B, snail, number modality (share of list items, trait / neutral)

NO BAN

654, 825, 996,
1167, 1338 …

digits only

→

STAGE 0 — *ban every digit*

Snail, Snail,
Snail, Snail …

snail 1.9% / 0%

→

STAGE 1 — *+ ban "snail"*

snai, snai,
snai …

sna…, sn… 2.6% / 0.001%

→

STAGE 2 — *+ ban "sna"*

snill, snoo,
snip, snit …

sn… 2.4% / 0.001%

each ban closes one channel; the excess appears at the nearest permitted neighbour

b Preference-chain length per trait and modality, prompted teachers (links / cap; 0 = no chain)

Qwen3-4B

	Num	Punct	Oper	Hex	DNA	Code
raven	15	6	0	16	10	1
snail	16	6	0	16	14	2
chub	16	8	0	16	11	1
loris	2	6	0	9	3	0
quoll	5	4	8	16	10	0
finch	4	7	0	9	16	1
warbler	16	6	0	16	10	5
slug	3	2	0	16	1	1
angry	5	8	0	16	10	1
anxious	1	1	6	16	16	1
bored	1	6	8	16	14	0
calm	0	8	8	16	16	1
content	16	8	6	16	16	1
excited	8	3	8	16	9	2
joyful	16	1	3	16	13	2
sad	1	8	8	16	16	2

Llama-3.2-3B

	Num	Punct	Oper	Hex	DNA	Code
raven	1	1	6	0	0	1
snail	1	3	6	0	0	0
chub	0	6	8	14	4	0
loris	0	3	5	2	1	0
quoll	1	5	8	0	0	0
finch	1	2	5	0	0	0
warbler	1	2	8	0	2	0
slug	1	2	6	0	0	1
angry	0	2	8	0	1	0
anxious	0	7	7	0	0	0
bored	0	2	1	0	0	3
calm	0	2	0	0	0	0
content	0	1	0	0	0	0
excited	0	4	1	0	0	0
joyful	0	2	5	0	2	0
sad	0	2	3	0	0	1

Rows 1–8 rare animals, 9–16 emotions. Fine-tuned teachers: 0 links in all 144 cells. Neutral prompts: 0 in all 24 null runs.